

THE QUARTER, READ HONESTLY

Prices held. Volume didn't.

Across Robina, Burleigh Waters and Varsity Lakes, house prices held their ground through Q2 2026 — but roughly half as many homes changed hands as a year ago, and a tax change announced in May began rewriting the investment case. This is a market cooling by activity, not by value.

FIELDS CONVICTION INDEX · COMPOSITE

94.4

Our single reading of price, sales volume and days-on-market, measured against each suburb's own five-year history. 100 marks balanced conditions. **Down from 100.1 in Q1** — below its baseline for the first time since early 2025.

ROBINA

89.8

▼ from 100.4

BURLEIGH WATERS

94.8

▼ from 97.2

VARSITY LAKES

103.0

● held above 100



How the Index works

Scan or visit

fieldsestate.com.au/conviction-index

THE QUARTER

A loud sale in a quiet market

On a Friday afternoon in April, on a lakefront street in Robina, bidding closed on a single-level home with twenty-two metres of water frontage. The hammer fell at \$2,410,000 — more than double what the house last changed hands for in 2020. It was one of the loudest moments of the quarter. Most of the quarter was quiet.

That contrast is the story of Q2 2026. Judged by the trailing-twelve-month median — the measure that doesn't lurch on a handful of sales — prices in all three suburbs held or rose. Judged by how many homes actually sold, the quarter was among the thinnest in years: turnover ran roughly half its year-earlier level, listings built up, and homes took longer to find a buyer. With the RBA cash rate at 4.35% after three rises this year, and a tax change announced mid-quarter, the pressure landed on **activity**, **not price**.

When this report last read the market, at the close of Q1 2026, the Conviction Index sat at 100.1 — right on the line between balanced and cooling. A quarter later it reads 94.4. The softening the volume figures hinted at then has now shown up in the composite. Nothing here suggests prices falling; it suggests a market catching its breath.

WHAT FIRMED

- Trailing-12-month median still rising in all three suburbs
- Wages (+3.4%) and household spending — the best leading indicators — both still climbing
- Burleigh Waters' average time-to-sell fell sharply (60.8 → 42.5 days)

WHAT SOFTENED

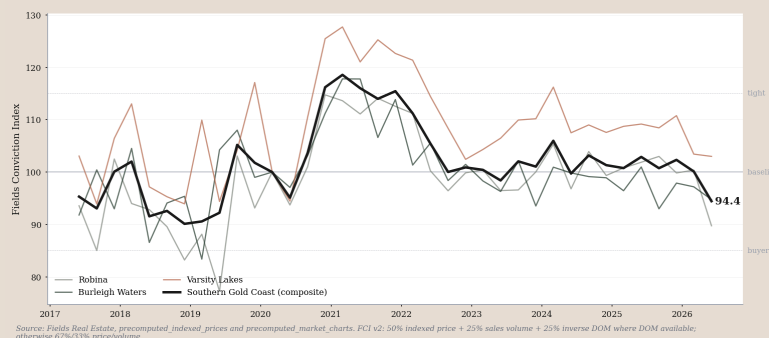
- Single-quarter sales down 44–56% on a year earlier
- Listings building; days-on-market lengthening in Robina and Varsity Lakes
- The Conviction Index below its 100 baseline (94.4)

WHAT TO WATCH

- The 1 July 2027 negative-gearing & CGT changes (page 5)
- The 11 August RBA decision; Q2 CPI lands 29 July
- Whether sellers meet the market, or buyers return first

The Fields Conviction Index since Q1 2017

Q1 2020 baseline = 100. Composite is transaction-weighted across the three core suburbs.



The Conviction Index since 2017 (composite in bold). It has eased to 94.4 — its first move below the 100 baseline since early 2025.

The question for the second half of 2026: which gives first — sellers adjusting to thinner demand, or buyers returning as the rate cycle settles? The data doesn't answer it yet. It tells us where the tension sits.

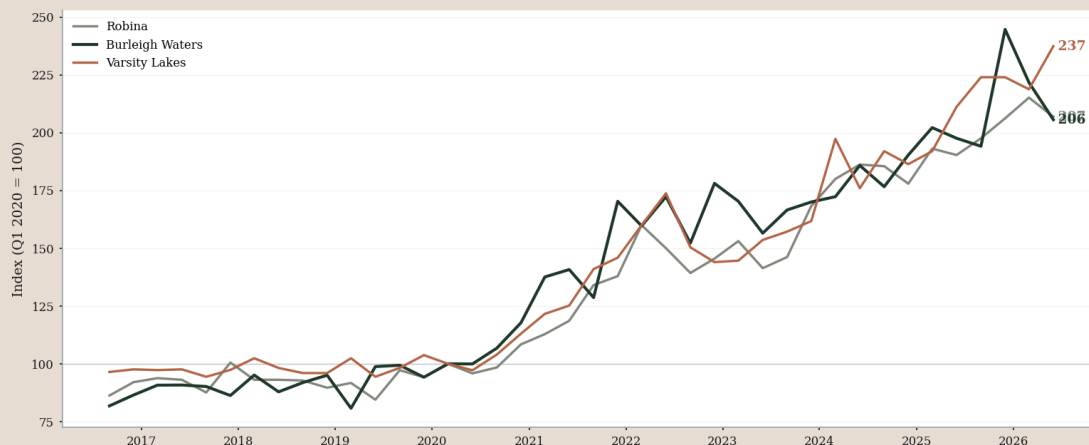
WHAT PRICES DID

The trend held. The quarter wobbled.

Single-quarter medians run on just 12–26 house sales and swing on a single unusual result. The trailing-twelve-month line — 90 to 140 sales — is the honest trend. This quarter the two disagree, and the trend is the one to trust.

Indexed median price by suburb, Q1 2020 = 100

Robina, Burleigh Waters and Varsity Lakes have risen 2.1–2.4× since the start of 2020.



Source: `precomputed_indexed_prices.indexed_series`. Quarterly Houses only, deduplicated across three sources. Sample sizes per quarter in the appendix.

Indexed median house price by suburb, Q1 2020 = 100. All three have risen 2.1–2.4× since 2020.

SUBURB	MEDIAN (Q2 2026)	YOY	QOQ	TRAILING-12M TREND
Robina	\$1,500,000	+8.7%	-3.8%	Rising, decelerating
Burleigh Waters	\$1,790,000	+4.1%	-7.3%	Rising, accelerating (+5.6%)
Varsity Lakes	\$1,484,000	+12.4%	+8.5%*	Rising (+1.4%)

*Varsity Lakes' single quarter ran on just 12 sales — read the trailing trend, not the quarter.

The pattern is consistent: where a single quarter shows a price fall — Burleigh Waters -7.3%, Robina -3.8% — it does so on a thin sample, against a rolling line that is still climbing. Burleigh Waters' trailing median is not merely rising but accelerating. What has changed is not the price of a home that sells; it is how many homes are selling, and how long they take.

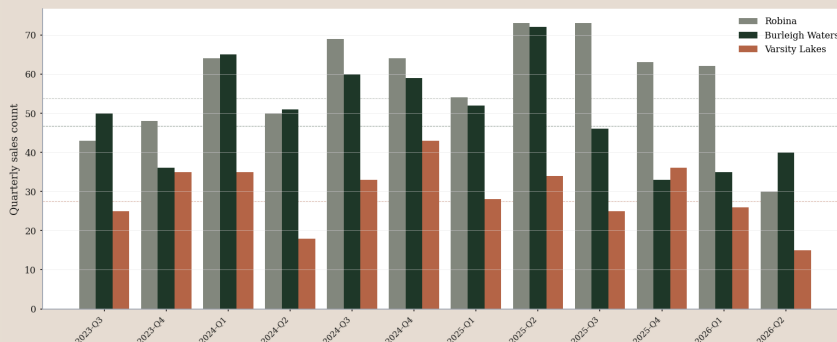
Rolling prices up, single quarters wobbling — which is the signal? On the weight of transactions, the trailing line. The wobble is what a thin quarter looks like.

WHAT ACTIVITY DID — THE REAL STORY

Fewer sales, slower sales

Quarterly sales volume by suburb

Latest complete quarter, 2026-Q2: Robina 30 (-44% vs 5-yr avg); Burleigh Waters 40 (-15% vs 5-yr avg); Varsity Lakes 15 (-45% vs 5-yr avg). The in-progress quarter is excluded.

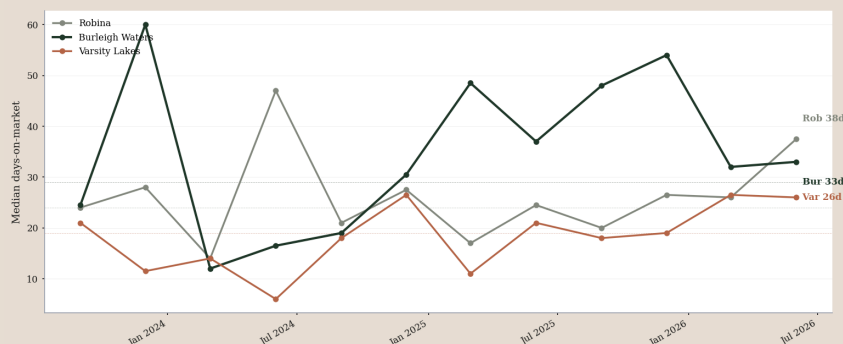


Source: precomputed_market_charts.(suburb)_sales_volume. Houses only, deduplicated. Dashed lines show each suburb's historical quarterly average.

Quarterly house sales, deduplicated. Q2 2026 ran below each suburb's five-year average and well below a year earlier.

Median days-on-market by suburb

Days-on-market has lengthened in Robina and Varsity Lakes; Burleigh Waters is essentially in line with its historical median. Dashed lines show each suburb's historical median.



Source: precomputed_market_charts.(suburb)_days_on_market. List-to-unconditional, private-treaty + auction combined. Sample sizes per quarter in the appendix.

Median days-on-market. Robina and Varsity Lakes have slowed; Burleigh Waters sits near its long-run median.

READING THE DAYS-ON-MARKET CURVE

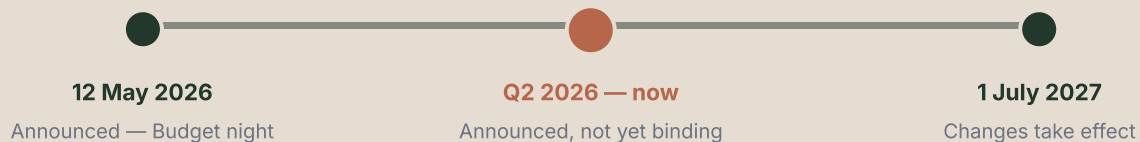
Time-on-market is the market's patience gauge. A settled home's clock runs longest in its first weeks; interest is highest early, then eases. When the median stretches — Robina from 24 to 38 days over the year — it means more homes are sitting past that early window before a buyer commits. Prices can hold while this happens: it is buyers taking longer to decide, not sellers dropping their price.

When homes take longer to sell but prices hold, someone is being patient. The data doesn't yet say who blinks — the seller who trims, or the buyer who returns.

THE RULE CHANGE BENEATH THE NUMBERS

A tax reform enters the calculus

On Budget night, 12 May 2026, the Federal Government announced the biggest change to property tax settings in a generation. It doesn't take effect until 1 July 2027 — but it landed inside this quarter, and it is already part of how buyers and sellers are thinking.



NEGATIVE GEARING

From 1 July 2027, investors who buy **established** homes after 12 May 2026 can no longer offset rental losses against their wages. Properties owned before Budget night are fully grandfathered, and **new builds stay fully negatively gearable** — a deliberate nudge toward new supply.

CAPITAL GAINS TAX

The 50% CGT discount is replaced by cost-base indexation plus a 30% minimum tax on net gains, for gains accruing from 1 July 2027. Gains built up before that date keep the old treatment.

The Commonwealth Bank estimates the package leaves established house prices about **3% lower than they otherwise would have been**, with a smaller effect on rents. The southern Gold Coast's \$700,000–\$1,300,000 mid-market has drawn steady investor interest, so this is the segment most exposed — while first-home buyers are being pushed the other way: the 5% deposit guarantee had its income and place caps removed in October 2025, and the Help to Buy shared-equity scheme (QLD price cap \$1,000,000) now reaches all three suburbs.

What the data shows — and what it can't. In the two months after the announcement, volumes fell and listings rose across all three suburbs. But three rate rises and the tax announcement landed in the very same window, so the slowdown can't be pinned on any single cause — and because the change doesn't bind until 2027, its fuller effect on established-property demand is still ahead, not in these prints. We've shown the overlap rather than pretend one explanation.

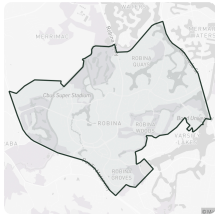
WHY MARKETS GO QUIET

When rates rise and the rules change at once, buyers and sellers both wait — not because anyone is being foolish, but because uncertainty has a real cost, and waiting is how a market absorbs it. Thinner volume is what caution looks like in the data. It is a normal phase of a cycle, not a verdict on value.

For a market where investors have been active buyers, the question isn't whether the 2027 change matters — it's how much of it has already been priced in.

THREE SUBURBS, THREE READINGS

The composite hides the divergence



Robina

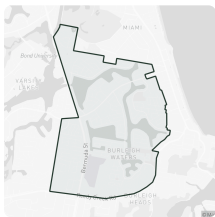
Conviction Index

89.8 ▼ from 100.4

Median **\$1,500,000** YoY **+8.7%** Days on market **37.5** (was 24.5) Q2 sales **30** (from 73)
Active listings **59** Absorption **4.1 mo**

The broad mid-market is where the squeeze shows most: the deepest buyer pool also means the most listings and the softest single-quarter print. The trailing median is still rising, but its pace shrinks each quarter — conditions have moved from a seller's market toward balance.

The most-listed of the three. Does depth cushion it, or expose it first?



Burleigh Waters

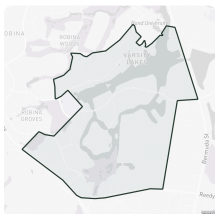
Conviction Index

94.8 ▼ from 97.2

Median **\$1,790,000** YoY **+4.1%** Days on market **33** (avg 60.8 → 42.5)
Q2 sales **40** (from 72) Active listings **40** Absorption **3.9 mo**

The single-quarter median fell from a thin, peak-distorted Q4 2025 — but every supply-side signal points the other way: turnover eased from an elevated 2025 rather than collapsing, listings are falling, average selling times dropped sharply, and the trailing median is accelerating. Cooling by volume, not by value.

The only suburb where the trend is speeding up. Can it hold as volume normalises?



Varsity Lakes

Conviction Index

103.0 • held

Median **\$1,484,000 (12 sales)** YoY **+12.4%** Days on market **26** (was 21)
Q2 sales **15** (from 34) Active listings **25** (was 12) Absorption **3.1 mo**

The only suburb still above its conviction baseline — the entry price point kept drawing bids, helped by first-home-buyer support, and the trailing median is still rising. But activity is decelerating hard: turnover roughly halved year-on-year and listings doubled in a month. Historically activity moves first and price follows.

Price is still firm while activity cools fast. Which one is the leading signal?

THE EVIDENCE, IN THREE SALES

What the transactions show

The charts describe the market. These settled sales show it — quality homes still clearing, but buyers with a little more room to negotiate.



ROBINA · TOP-END DEPTH

138 Camberwell Circuit

5 bed · 3 bath · 4 car · 920 m² · lakefront, 22 m water frontage

Sold \$2,410,000 · auction · 17 April 2026

The sale that opened this report. Taken to auction rather than listed with a price, it sold on the day — well above Robina's ~\$1,500,000 median, and more than double the \$960,000 paid in 2020. Where a home sits outside the ordinary comparable set, a public deadline still concentrates competition. Depth remains at the distinctive top end, even as broad turnover thins.



BURLEIGH WATERS · CLOSE TO ASK

22 Lanai Drive

4 bed · 2 bath · 2 car · single-level family home

Sold \$1,640,000 · guided "offers considered \$1,695,000" · 23 July 2026

A four-bedroom home guided at \$1,695,000 that settled at \$1,640,000 — about 3% under guide. Close to ask, but with room to negotiate: the profile of the quarter, where homes are still clearing while buyers no longer pay the top of the range.



VARSITY LAKES · PRICE HOLDS, URGENCY EASES

16 South Bay Drive

3 bed · 2 bath · 2 car · lake outlook

Sold \$1,250,000 · guided "offers over \$1,290,000" · 9 July 2026

Guided over \$1,290,000, sold at \$1,250,000 — again about 3% below guide. Priced to a lake-facing position, it moved without the urgency of a year ago, matching Varsity Lakes' easing activity and still-firm pricing.

The throughline. Across all three, quality homes settled roughly 3% under a firm guide. Not capitulation — modest negotiating room returning to buyers while vendors hold their line. The same story the Conviction Index tells, read in three transactions rather than three charts.

THE MACRO BACKDROP

What's pushing, what's pulling

INDICATOR (QLD)	LATEST	TREND	READ FOR PRICES
Wage growth	3.4%	↑	Supportive — leads prices ($r \approx 0.94$)
Household spending	\$22.3B	↑	Supportive — real-time demand ($r \approx 0.91$)
Housing lending	\$12.2B	↓	Cautionary — but lags ~3.5 months
New dwelling supply	8,020	↓	Supportive — less new competition
Inflation (CPI)	4.2%	↓	Supportive — eases rate pressure
RBA cash rate	4.35%	↑	Cautionary — three rises in 2026
ASX All Ordinaries	8,996	→	Neutral

WHAT THIS REPORT WON'T TELL YOU

It won't tell you what your home is worth — that takes the specifics of your street and your house, not a suburb median. It won't predict where prices go next; we report indicators and use conditional language, never forecasts. And it can't fully separate the effect of three rate rises from the 12 May tax announcement — both landed in the same three months, so we've shown you the overlap rather than pick a story. If we get a read wrong, the next edition will say so.

How the numbers are built. House transactions across Robina (4226), Burleigh Waters (4220) and Varsity Lakes (4227). Quarterly medians can swing on small samples (Q2 2026: 12–26 sales per suburb), so trend claims lean on the trailing-12-month median (90–140 sales). The Fields Conviction Index is a composite z-score of price, sales volume and days-on-market, each measured against the suburb's own five-year history and rebased to Q1 2020 = 100 — full method at fieldsestate.com.au/conviction-index. Macro indicators from ABS and RBA; policy detail from ATO, [Budget.gov.au](https://budget.gov.au) and CBA. Prices shown are exact recorded transaction figures. Data close 30 June 2026; case-study sales settled through 23 July 2026. Sources: Fields Real Estate, Domain, ABS, RBA, ATO. This report presents data and analysis for information only — it is not personal or financial advice, and makes no forecast of future prices.

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